

With a little tweaking, you can use this same class on any other list whose items you wish to display incrementally. It isn't confined to text; you can create incremental image animations using the same method, and overlapping a set of images, as shown in the following code (taken from the sample presentation on the S5 website). The size of the images will be different in each case. You will have to experiment with the settings to get the exact positioning you want. Alternately, you can create a separate division, and set the images as the background of that division.

```
<style type="text/css" media="all">
.img0L {width: 525px; margin: 0 auto; padding: 0; text-align: center;}
#animation {width: 270px; height: 320px; position: relative; margin-top: 0.5em;}
#animation img {position: absolute; top: 42px; left: 24px;}
imgimg01 {top: 0; left: 0;}
imgimg02 {left: 23px;}
imgimg03 {top: 44px;}
imgimg04 {top: 43px; left: 36px;}
</style>

<p class="img0L" id="animation">




</p>
```

S5 now also supports the alpha channels of PNG images, which greatly enhances the capability of image animations.

Themes

At this point, you probably have a fully functional slide show—however, dressing it up with themes is a different matter altogether. The default S5 theme is not very elegant, and most of us would want to either modify it, or create a new one. Creating a theme requires a thorough knowledge of CSS and HTML, and might not be for everyone—but there are plenty of user-created themes available on the Internet (see the bibliography).

Using a custom theme is very easy: first, you download the theme package and explode (extract) it. It might have a slightly different directory structure than that of the default S5, but the core objects remain the same.

You might see a file called `index.html` in many themes—this is where your content should go (you could just rename it and replace it with a copy of your existing presentation file). You most probably won't have to make any other modifications to your presentation to change the theme, although in some cases, the default stylesheet is changed from `slides.css` to something else. For more details, check the sample usage of the theme you are using.

S5 reloaded

The development of S5 stalled after the release of 1.2 alpha, but with S5-Reloaded, we have what we could call S5 1.3.

S5 functional hierarchy

The diagram in Figure 5 shows the relationship between S5 files, and briefly describes the core files.

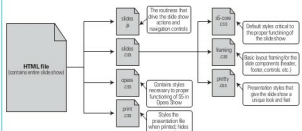


Figure 5: S5 functional hierarchy [Image courtesy of Eric Meyer, developer of S5; taken from the S5 introductory slide show.]

The most important file is `slides.js`, which makes S5 work. Menu and slide display, slide indexing—everything is controlled by this file, so be careful when making any changes. It also handles the downgrade when using Opera (for compatibility with Opera Show).

The `slides.css` file calls the other files `s5-core`, `framing` and `pretty`. The `s5-core.css` file handles all the core display functions of the slide show.

The `framing.css` file contains all the positioning rules like the position of title, footer, header, etc. The `pretty.css` file has everything you need to make a new theme. You can conjure up a new design just by making a few changes to this file alone. Whether the result is pretty or not entirely depends on you!

It improves upon the original S5 in many ways. Besides the earlier-mentioned automatic scaling of images, additional features include fade-out effects, automatic slide show (based on timers), slide transition sound, configurable auto-play, and an enhanced control panel.

To have automatic image scaling, add the class `scale` to the image element, and it will take care of the image size. Figure 4 shows the configuration parameters for some of the S5-Reloaded features.

S5-Reloaded has done away with several shortcomings of the original S5, making it a formidable player among Web-based presentation systems. 

Bibliography

- S5 Website: <http://meyerweb.com/eric/tools/s5/>
- S5-Reloaded Website: <http://www.netgusta.de/S5/>
- S5-Themes: <http://atuan.com/s5/>

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